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W E D N E S D A Y , J A N U A R Y 1 5 , 2 0 2 5

Conviction was likely for Trump, report says

Special counsel’s rebuke caps case involving election interference

By Alan Feuer and Charlie Savage
NEW YORK TIMES

Jack Smith, the special counsel who indicted President-elect Donald Trump on charges of illegally seeking to cling to power after losing the 2020 election, said in a final report released early Tuesday that the evidence would have been sufficient to convict Trump in a trial, had his 2024 election victory not made it impossible for the prosecution to continue.

“The department’s view that the Constitution prohibits the continued indictment and prosecution of a president is categorical and does not turn on the gravity of the crimes charged, the strength of the government’s proof or the merits of the prosecution, which the office stands fully behind,” Smith wrote.

He continued: “Indeed, but for Mr. Trump’s election and imminent return to the presidency, the office assessed that the admissible evidence was sufficient to obtain and sustain a conviction at trial.”

The Justice Department delivered the 137-page volume to Congress just after midnight Tuesday. It represents half of Smith’s overall final report, with the volume about Trump’s other federal case, accusing him of mishandling classified documents, still confidential.

The report amounted to an extraordinary rebuke of a president-elect, capping a momentous legal saga that saw the man now poised to regain the powers of the nation’s highest of

REPORT, Page A7

Fierce winds increase peril, anxiety in LA

Utility cuts some power amid ominous warnings

By Sam Stanton and Claire Moses
NEW YORK TIMES

OXNARD, Calif. — Intense wind gusts sweeping across Southern California on Tuesday threatened to drive some of the most destructive wildfires in the state’s history into new areas and ignite additional fires that could endanger lives, officials said.

As a utility shut off power to tens of thousands of customers as a preventive measure, fire chiefs and other officials urged residents in fire-prone areas to be prepared to evacuate quickly. The National Weather Service issued an exceptionally rare warning for “particularly dangerous” weather that could lead to “explosive fire growth.”

The warning, which covered Los Angeles and Ventura counties, cautioned that gusts of 45 to 70 miles per hour and very low humidity were creating ideal conditions for fires across the region’s parched landscape of brush and grass.

The weather service’s Los Angeles office had

FIRES, Page A7

‘I do not believe that you are qualified to meet the overwhelming demands of this job.’

SENATOR JACK REED *ranking member of the Senate Armed Services Committee, to Pete Hegseth*

Advise and dissent



ANNA MONEYMAKER/GETTY IMAGES

Donald Trump “believes, and I humbly agree, that it’s time to give someone with dust on his boots the helm,” Pete Hegseth said.

Hegseth defends self in hearing as Democrats attack conduct, experience

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Rhode Island Senator Jack Reed is no partisan firebrand. The soft-spoken Democrat voted for all nine previous defense secretary nominees, no matter the political party, since arriving in the Senate in 1997.

So when Reed, 75, a West Point graduate, declared at the start of Tuesday’s Senate Armed Services Committee confirmation hearing for defense secretary nominee Pete Hegseth that the controversial pick would not get his vote, it quickly set the tone for a highly contentious affair.

“Mr. Hegseth, I do not believe that you are qualified to meet the overwhelming demands

of this job,” Reed said.

None of the other dozen Democrats on the committee appeared to believe Hegseth, an Army veteran and Fox News personality, was qualified to run one of the largest and most complex institutions in the world, with about 3 million military and civilian employees and an annual budget of more than \$800 billion.

During the 4½-hour hearing — the first for a Trump nominee — Democrats pummeled Hegseth with questions about his background, including accusations of sexual misconduct, excessive drinking, and financial mismanagement of two small veterans organizations, as well as his past statements that women should not serve in combat.

But Republicans on the committee ap-

peared solidly behind Hegseth, who described himself as an unconventional “change agent,” a former soldier who will restore a “warrior ethos” to the military and end the “woke” policies under President Biden. They included Iowa Senator Joni Ernst, an Army National Guard member who served in Kuwait and Iraq and had seemed skeptical of Hegseth’s nomination last month but has recently sounded more supportive after meetings with him and a sharp backlash from conservatives.

“It is true ... that I don’t have a similar biography to defense secretaries of the last 30 years,” Hegseth said in an opening statement interrupted three times by protesters.

“But, as President Trump also told me,

HEGSETH, Page A6

Condo residents fear they will not go home again

Building was emptied over safety concerns, but costs, tensions mount

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — They had planned to spend retirement there. Then late last year, amid grave concerns about newly discovered structural issues in the building’s concrete, residents of the 66-unit Riverview condo building had to evacuate their homes in a hurry. They believed they would need to be away for as little as a year before they could move back.

Now residents, most of them seniors, are facing difficult choices about what comes next and confronting the very real possibility that they might never return home.

Some have lived in the white-concrete building along the picturesque Charles River, which was built in the early 1960s, for decades. Others had moved there only recently. In weekly meetings in recent months with the company that manages the

building, they have learned that the building may be too expensive to fix and therefore unsalvageable — and ripe for being demolished, according to several unit owners with knowledge of the discussions who spoke with the Globe.

“We all need to go through the five stages of grief,” said Linda Salter, 78, who said she bought a unit in the building only two years ago. “Everything is on the table.”

Outside consultants are exploring the different paths residents could take. A “detailed fi-

CONDO, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Residents of the Riverview condos have learned that fixing the Cambridge building may be too expensive to be feasible.

Mom politicians credit Wu’s example

Between high demands and naysayers, they find balance and support



CONOR PEWARSKI

Mira Wu Pewarski, the third child of Mayor Michelle Wu and Conor Pewarski, was born Monday.

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Mayor Michelle Wu delivered a healthy baby girl Monday, shattering yet another barrier in the city’s history as she welcomed her third child, Mira Wu Pewarski, weighing 8 pounds, 4 ounces.

Both mother and daughter are doing well, Wu’s husband, Conor Pewarski, said in an email to supporters that included a photo of the couple’s sons, Blaise and Cass, holding their new sister.

► Mayor to forgo parental leave for “working leave,” B1.

“Michelle and baby are happy and healthy, and as you can see, the boys are already in love with their new little sister,” he wrote.

The first woman, mother, and person of color to be elected mayor of Boston, Wu, who turned 40 Tuesday, is one member of a tiny but growing group of prominent women politicians who have not only led and legislated while raising young children, but delivered those children while serving in office. It’s another weighty milestone in a country where mothers are still all too often punished at work and in public perception for daring to take

WU, Page A10

Needham votes down housing plan

Voters in Needham soundly rejected a plan that would have allowed more multifamily housing and would have aligned the town with a state housing law. **B1.**

Israel and Hamas were closing in on a cease-fire that would include freeing some of the hostages in Gaza, according to Secretary of State Antony Blinken. **A3.**

Enrollment in Boston Public Schools rose for the first time in a decade, an increase attributed to the influx of immigrants. **B1.**



Half ray there

Wednesday: Lots of sun, wind. High 29-34, low 15-20.

Thursday: Clouds move in. High 28-33, low 21-26.

Sunrise: 7:11. Sunset: 4:37.

Weather and comics, **G6-7.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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